conventional interpretations explain the presence of the correct answer? *Where was it computed?*" Other interpretations of quantum physics would also prove capable of explaining the power of quantum computers. Nonetheless, Deutsch's enthusiasm was infectious, and many-worlds soon gained in popularity within the new field of quantum information processing.

Many-worlds also continued to gain in popularity among physicists who took cosmology seriously—and even inspired new interpretations. "Measurements and observers cannot be fundamental notions in a theory that seeks to discuss the early universe when neither existed," wrote Murray Gell-Mann and James Hartle in 1990. Gell-Mann had won a Nobel Prize in 1969 for suggesting the existence of quarks; Hartle, his former student, had done work on quantum cosmology with Stephen Hawking. Both had long been convinced that the Copenhagen interpretation had to be wrong. "The fact that an adequate philosophical presentation [of quantum physics] has been so long delayed is no doubt caused by the fact that Niels Bohr brainwashed a whole generation of theorists," Gell-Mann wrote in 1976. Gell-Mann and Hartle combined Everett's interpretation with the work on decoherence done by Zeh, Joos, and Zurek, along with ideas from Roland Omnès and Robert Griffiths, to develop what they called the "decoherent-histories" interpretation of quantum physics. Despite the fact that their interpretation had a single world, Gell-Mann and Hartle acknowledged their intellectual debt to Everett and saw their ideas as an extension of his work.

But Everett didn't live to see Gell-Mann's work, or Deutsch's. On July 19, 1982, Everett died of a heart attack at the age of fifty-one. In accordance with his wishes, his family had him cremated, and left his ashes out with the trash.

Within a decade of Everett's death, cosmology entered a golden age. For much of the previous century, the field had been driven primarily by theoretical advances, such as the development of general relativity in the first place. But in the 1990s, the Hubble Space Telescope, the Cosmic Microwave Background Explorer, and other space-based observatories,